SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #40 · LIFE-STAGE PRESSURES

“Needing help means losing my dignity.”

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Where it often comes from

Many of us learned that independence is a mark of maturity and that asking for help is a loss of standing. Pride, family pride, or past experiences when help came with humiliation can feed this belief. It can keep people from using resources, seeing doctors, accepting meals, or asking for a loan or a ride when they truly need one.

What Scripture teaches

The psalmist says of humanity, “You made him a little lower than the angels; You crowned him with glory and honor.” That honor does not depend on how much we need. Jesus said, “It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick,” and Paul reminds us that it is more blessed to give than to receive, which means someone must receive. Proverbs says that with humility comes wisdom. Asking for help is a way to honor God’s design, in which we are made to need Him and each other.

> *“Jesus answered, ‘It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick.’”* (Luke 5:31).

Also see

> “You made him a little lower than the angels; You crowned him with glory and honor” (Psalm 8:5).

> “In everything, I showed you that by this kind of hard work we must help the weak, remembering the words of the Lord Jesus Himself: ‘It is more blessed to give than to receive.’” (Acts 20:35).

> “When pride comes, disgrace follows, but with humility comes wisdom” (Proverbs 11:2).

> “Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ” (Galatians 6:2).

Common self-statements

- Real adults do not need help.
- If I ask, I am admitting defeat.
- People will lose respect for me.
- I would rather struggle alone than owe anyone.
- Taking help means I am weak.
- Needing anything is humiliating.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing that I am either independent and dignified or needy and shamed.
- Mind reading: Assuming people will think less of me.
- Should statements: Insisting that I should never need help.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling embarrassed and concluding that asking is wrong.

Challenging questions

- Where did I learn that asking for help is a loss?
- What would I think of a friend who asked me for help?
- When have I helped someone, and how did it feel?
- What does it cost me when I refuse help?

- What does God's crown of glory and honor say about my dignity?
- What is one small request I could make this week?

Truth summary

> My dignity comes from being made in God's image and crowned with glory and honor, not from how little I need. Asking for help is wise and humble, and it gives others the blessing of giving. I can receive help with gratitude and keep my dignity.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Help
- Humility
- Pride
- Weakness
- Friendship

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Pride

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

What a Friend We Have in Jesus — Keith and Kristyn Getty
This classic hymn invites direct, honest prayer with the Savior who carries our burdens.

Amazing Grace — Reawaken Hymns
This classic hymn locates salvation and sustaining hope in grace rather than merit.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "Needing help means losing my dignity"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Needing help means losing my dignity." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Where did I learn that asking is shameful?
- ☐ What do I need right now?
- ☐ What would I say to a friend who asked me?
- ☐ What does asking cost me?
- ☐ What is one small request?
- ☐ How can I say thank you well?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ My dignity comes from God.
- ☐ Asking for help is wise.
- ☐ Receiving lets others give.
- ☐ We were made to need each other.
- ☐ Humility brings wisdom.
- ☐ I can accept help and still be honored.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Luke 5:31**
  "Jesus answered, 'It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick.'"
- ☐ **Psalm 8:5**
  "You made him a little lower than the angels; You crowned him with glory and honor."
- ☐ **Acts 20:35**
  "In everything, I showed you that by this kind of hard work we must help the weak, remembering the words of the Lord Jesus Himself: 'It is more blessed to give than to receive.'"

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ A request made: Each week, note one time you asked for or accepted help and how it went.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 8:5 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God crowned me with glory and honor, so I can ask for help without losing my dignity.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Help" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- ☐ Name your needs. Write what you need right now: practical, financial, emotional, or physical.
- ☐ Make one small request. Ask a friend, church, or professional for one specific thing.
- ☐ Say thank you. Respond to help with gratitude instead of apology.
- ☐ Help someone else. Notice how it feels to be asked, and remember it.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Needing help means losing my dignity": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A request made
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Needing help means losing my dignity.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You crowned me with honor. Free me from the belief that needing help takes it away. Give me humility to ask, gratitude to receive, and trust that You provide through people. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.